that - clause marker

The above sentence is an example of a complex sentence.

A complex sentence has one Main clause and one or more Subordinate clauses.

Task 1

Look at the following complex sentences. Circle the Main clauses and underline the Subordinate clauses.

a) Nobody knows when the power supply will resume.

b) Please tell me what the time is.

c) The man who directed the film was my schoolmate.

d) I believe that all men are basically good.

e) No one knows when he will return.

Task 2

Pick out the complex sentences in the following passage.

A man saw a lion in the bush, as he was walking through the forest. He did not know what to do. He was helpless. He was too scared to turn around and run. He just knelt down as if he were getting ready to pray. He closed his eyes, thinking that the lion would pounce on him anytime. Out of the corner of his eye, he saw the lion on its knees too. Shocked, he asked the lion what it was doing. The lion replied that he was praying before he started his meal.

c) Compound sentence

Look at the following sentence:

Honesty promotes character, and dishonesty destroys it.

Honesty promotes character - Main clause I

dishonesty destroys it - Main clause II

and - conjunction

Two Main clauses connected by a conjunction form a compound sentence.

Task 1

Identify the two Main clauses and conjunction in each of the following sentences.

a) It started raining suddenly and people ran for shelter.

b) Understand the concept well, otherwise you cannot solve the problem.

c) Fifty candidates appeared for the interview, but only five were selected.

d) Ramesh did not know Spanish, so he wanted a translator.

e) He is a good actor, still he is not popular.

Task 2

Pick out the compound sentences in the following passage.

The food we eat has to be digested and then thrown out of the body. The air we breathe in, has to be thrown out, to help us survive. But we hold negative emotions like insecurity, anger and jealousy within ourselves for years. If these negative emotions are not eliminated, the mind grows corrupt and diseased. Let us do away with hatred and lead a healthy life filled with peace and joy.

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